

from industrial. In a sense, he replaced one technology with another, while making it much more accessible and affordable to the masses, even though all he did was essentially pottery.

So as you see, our confined view of technology is not what a maker adheres to. A maker's work might involve, apart from traditional electronics, things like food, artwork, crafting and daily use materials. Typically, the maker movement puts to use several engineering-oriented pursuits like electronics, 3D printing, robotics, CNC (Computerised Numerical Control) tools and more traditional methods of metal and wood working. But that is not what we differentiate makers by. This is where the differentiation moves from outside the maker culture to within it. The scope of innovation is so immense right now, that differentiating one type of maker from another is a daunting task and so is identifying which area an innovation falls into. It is only at a macro level that we can see several trends in the way makers work which let us identify certain segments.

To learn or to earn – The different types of makers

- ♦ The DIY-oriented makers are essentially hobbyists, their primary skill-set is tinkering based on their existing knowledge and whatever new they can find out every day. They are more focussed on developing their repertoire without giving up on their day job.
- ♦ How-to videos on YouTube, open source code from Github, tips and tricks from favourite forums – these are what comprise the daily diet of the Self Learning makers. Not really afraid to ask silly questions and learn from experience, these makers have a compelling desire to go beyond 'connecting A to B makes C' and ask all the 'why's required to understand the tools they use every day.
- ♦ There is another type of maker that identifies most with teaching and explaining things to those eager to learn. These teachers are the type of people you turn to for advice on your next project and find them taking more than passing interest in your progress. Perhaps the most well enmeshed in the community out of all types of makers, they take special interest in connecting their knowledge of different fields and subjects into creative applications that solve a problem.
- ♦ With industry grade technologies like 3D printing and circuit makers now readily accessible, the rise of the 'Professional' maker is not really a surprise. Constantly bringing new tools into their arsenal, their main focus is on efficiency and gradually scaling up. Their work comprises